

Making Polymers: **GREEN SLIME**

The slime you will make is an example of reversible, cross-linked gel that is a polymer of guar **gum** and **borax**. The result is a soft, flowing, non-sticking substance that should last for some time, as long as it doesn't dry out.

Material: plastic cup, small teaspoon, measuring cylinders, 100ml. water, 5 ml. glycerol, 15 ml. borax, 1 level teaspoon of guar gum.

Method:

- 1) Measure and pour 100ml of water into the cup. Add 5ml of glycerol to the water and stir well.
- 2) Add 3 drops of food colouring to the liquid and stir.
- 3) Slowly sprinkle a levelled teaspoon of guar into the liquid, stirring continuously with the stirring rod until all the guar dissolves. It will begin to thicken within 1 or 2 minutes.
- 4) Now add the borax solution 5ml at a time, stirring continuously. The solution will gel as you add more borax.
- 5) Test the slime to see if it sticks to the spoon. If it is still sticky, add another 5ml of borax and continue stirring.
- 6) When your slime is complete, store it in an airtight container to stop it from drying out.

The slime is a non-toxic, safe substance to handle. If it sticks to clothing rub it with vinegar and rinse with soapy water.

Have fun!!!